

The Battering Ram

Offensive, Arrogant

Inspired by: Siege-focused

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Siege Specialist: You begin the game with a Siege Works (no ward, no upkeep, always active Mastery). If a player builds a Citadel, you must Siege it as an Edict.

Pair: Siege Camp, Royal Pavilion

Complement: Senate Hall

The Boundless Steppe

Fast

Inspired by: Mongol Horde

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Horsemasters: Begin the game with a Stable which does not occupy a Settlement ward, cost Upkeep, and counts as an activated Mastery Effect which cannot be deactivated.

Pair: Saddlery, Royal Pavilion

Complement: Forge

The Bandit King

Scrappy

Inspired by: Brigands

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
LOW

Friends in Low Places: You begin the game with a Smuggler's Nook which does not occupy a Settlement ward, nor cost upkeep. You always gain its Mastery Effect, which cannot be deactivated. In addition, you may control one Bandit Camp outside your territory each turn. Every turn a Bandit Camp is generated, you may place it in your Outlaw Country instead.

Pair: Thieves' Guild, Saddlery

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Crowned Star

Sovereign Voice

Inspired by: Reigning Sovereign

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

The Monarch: Each Turn, you choose each Council Envoy's Domain. All Envoys you send gain Influence -1.

Pair: Senate Hall, Aristocratic Court

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Crimson Tide

Pirate Life

Inspired by: Pirate

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Sea Lanes: Other players cannot perform Intercept Caravan on you. You begin the game with a Shipyard that does not occupy a Settlement ward, does not cost upkeep, and always has the Mastery Effect, even if you do not have a Water Settlement.

Pair: Shipyard, Thieves' Guild

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Entwined Crown

Diplomatic, Inescapable

Inspired by: Habsburg Dynasty

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Royal Marriage: Once per game, you may join an Alliance without unanimous consent, or form an Alliance with a player who is not in one. Whoever is in that Alliance gains Faith +1 and +1 Influence per turn.

Pair: Aristocratic Court, Senate Hall

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Eternal Court

Patient & Reserved

Inspired by: Byzantine Empire

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Patient Court: Your influence is never wasted — unspent influence is not discarded in the Rest Phase. Once the Era is Zenith, you have a cap of 5 on influence you spend per envoy, regardless of your Domain Standing.

Pair: Senate Hall, Aristocratic Court

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Final Word

Cold Steel

Inspired by: Warlord Council

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

The Decider: Ignore the Innate Doubt & Influence Modifiers that are triggered for being at War.

Pair: Royal Pavilion, Imperial Palace

Complement: Senate Hall

The Gilded Crescent

Egalitarian

Inspired by: Moorish Caliphate

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Prosperity For All: Begin the game with an Inn which does not occupy a Settlement ward, cost Upkeep, and counts as an activated Mastery Effect which cannot be deactivated.

Pair: Meadery & Winery, Studium Generale

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Gilded Path

Rich Trader

Inspired by: Great Income

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
LOW

Silk Road: You begin the game with an Artisan Workshop (no ward, no upkeep, always active Mastery). However, you cannot refuse a Trade Agreement.

Pair: Meadery & Winery, Forge
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Hermit Crown

Independent

Inspired by: Independent

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
LOW

Independent, but Ambitious: You Abstain every Vote on other players' Envoys, and other players must use 2 Influence to affect your Envoys by 1. Gain Influence +1 to all Personal Envoys. You cannot vote on Council Envoys.

Pair: Studium Generale, Saddlery
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Illuminated Order

Knowledge is Power

Inspired by: Scholarly

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Knowledge is Power: For every 3 Pursuits, gain +1 Influence each turn.

Pair: Studium Generale, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Iron Faith

Piously Resolute

Inspired by: Crusader States

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Fortress of Faith: While Public Order is greater than or equal to 3, Lay Siege actions targeting Settlements you Control have Siege Timer +2.

Pair: Siege Camp, Preceptory of the Knight's Templar
Complement: Senate Hall

The Iron Shore

Scavenger

Inspired by: Norse

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Scavengers: Whether you win or lose a battle, collect the Spoils of War. You may also recoup the cost of the retinues received as Casualties in that Battle. Lastly, whenever you perform the Repair action, recoup its cost, even if it only passed.

Pair: Royal Pavilion, Shipyard
Complement: Forge

The Iron Throne

Defensive, Impenetrable

Inspired by: Defensive

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Unimpeachable: Begin the game with a Citadel (no ward, no upkeep, always active Mastery). You (or your alliance) cannot perform Declare War or Crusade.

Pair: Inquisitorial Palace, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Merchant Republics

Trade Dependent

Inspired by: Italian City States

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
HIGH

Heart of Trade: Begin the game with Stone Roads infrastructure, do not pay Upkeep, and cannot be Razed. In order for any player to be able to trade, they must trade with this player first, unless at War with this player. As soon as another player is eligible, you must attempt to Sign a Trade Agreement once with that player. You may not perform the End Treaty Diplomacy action.

Pair: Shipyard, Meadery & Winery
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Sacred Throne

Pure and Defensive

Inspired by: Papal State

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
HIGH

Sacrosanct: Players who declare war on you (and their allies) gain an additional Doubt +1.

Pair: Inquisitorial Palace, Preceptory of the Knight's Templar
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Tunnellers

Mountain Passers

Inspired by: Dwarves

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
LOW

Tunnellers: You treat mountain territory like grasslands for purposes of movement, and begin the game with a Mine raw material pursuit (no ward, no upkeep, always active Mastery).

Pair: Forge, Advanced Blast Furnace
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Undying Flame

Unconvinced
Inspired by: Martyrs

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
LOW

Martyrdom: Your armies Morale cannot be modified beyond 6+, but your armies continue to suffer -1 from Fatigue Tokens. Gain Faith +1 for every player you're at War with and every Battle where you lose 20 or more retinues, win or loss. Gain Immune War Weariness

Pair: Preceptory of the Knight's Templar, Inquisitorial Palace

Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Verdant Kingdom

Pure Economy
Inspired by: Industry

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
HIGH

Peaceful & Inventive: You cannot declare war, enter Military Alliances, perform Cunning actions, or build Pursuits that require Prowess or Cunning Standing. In the Income step, gain 100 gold for each Craft Mastery Effect you have active.

Pair: Forge, Advanced Blast Furnace, Meadery & Winery
Complement: Senate Hall

The Winter Wolves

Aggressive, Parasitic
Inspired by: Vikings

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Danegeld: Your armies do not pay upkeep in enemy territory when you're at war — the enemy player pays the upkeep instead. Do not gain Speed -1 in Winter.

Pair: Royal Pavilion, Shipyard
Complement: Forge

The Ancient Wilds

Oathkeepers
Inspired by: Celtic Kingdoms

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
HIGH

Highlander Way: Enemy armies gain Speed -1 in your Province. You ignore all Terrain Speed modifiers and may trade without Dirt Roads. You must accept the first Non-Aggression Pact offered by each player or Alliance. If that player later joins an alliance, this condition is considered satisfied for that alliance.

Pair: Royal Pavilion, Saddlery
Complement: Senate Hall

The Bloodied Cross

Holy War Without End
Inspired by: Crusading Sect

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
HIGH

Prophets of War: May Crusade at Rising Piety instead of Sovereign Piety, and do not have a cap on how many Crusades you may have active. All players receive Doubt +1 per Crusade you are on. You cannot perform convert actions.

Pair: Preceptory of the Knight's Templar, Inquisitorial Palace
Complement: Senate Hall

The Blazing Standard

Crusader Feel
Inspired by: Teutonic Knight

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
HIGH

Burning Cross: You begin the game with a Preceptory of the Knight's Templar (no ward, no upkeep, always active Mastery). If you Declared War via Crusade, that player must take a Panic Check at the beginning of every battle after lines are formed. If during the Prowess Envoy phase you do not have an army with 25 Knight's Templars, you must attempt to send an envoy. If it passes, you must muster an army until it has 25 retinues of Knight's Templar.

Pair: Preceptory of the Knight's Templar, Royal Pavilion
Complement: Senate Hall

The Inner Circle

Strength Through Diplomacy
Inspired by: Natural Leader

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Palatine: Players who are allied with you gain Influence +1 to their envoys, but you may spend 1 of their Influence each turn, targeting your own envoys if you wish.

Pair: Senate Hall, Aristocratic Court
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Luminous Court

Civic Soft Power
Inspired by: Renaissance

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Arts & Humanities / Hearts & Minds: Cannot pursue Craft Pursuits. Civic Pursuits gain Craft +1. All Civic Pursuits do not cost Upkeep. This Player must accept a Peace Treaty if offered one.

Pair: Studium Generale, Aristocratic Court, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Grand Compact

Peace Through Trade
Inspired by: Hanseatic League

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Mercantile Pact: If anyone Declares War on you, players with Trade Agreements with you must Declare War back or End Trade Agreement.

Pair: Shipyard, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Pale Throne

Undead

Inspired by: Undead

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
LOW

Inexorable: Your armies always have Unwieldy and cannot gain Immune Unwieldy, but also gain Recover +1, Speed -1, and Immune Panic. Your Public Order cannot exceed 1.

Pair: Preceptory of the Knight's Templar, Forge
Complement: Advanced Blast Furnace

The Sublime Gate

Mercantile Military

Inspired by: Ottoman Empire

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Integrated Arms: You may Muster retinues and equipment from your Trade Partners' Pursuits (and Mastery Effects, if active) for their cost when you perform a muster action.

Pair: Forge, Advanced Blast Furnace
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Velvet Hand

Generous Sponsor

Inspired by: Patrons

DIFFICULTY
MEDIUM

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Friends in High Places: At the beginning of the turn, players gain Faith +1 if they supported an envoy you sent and it was passed. And, if it was endorsed, they Extort 500 gold per Era.

Pair: Aristocratic Court, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Ashen Vale

Sickly

Inspired by: Plague

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
LOW

Pestilence: Each bordering player gains Doubt +1, your settlements gain Reach +1, and all retinues gain Poison. You may not pursue an Apothecary, Infirmary, or Hospitaller.

Pair: Thieves' Guild, Inquisitorial Palace
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Broken Banner

Always for Sale

Inspired by: Mercenary

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
LOW

The Highest Bidder: You cannot Declare War and cannot be the Target of a Declare War action. However you must sign any Military or Defensive Alliance offered to you by the highest bidding player each turn and must be paid each turn. In order to overturn an existing alliance, the player must pay a higher amount than the prior agreement. You cannot sign or end alliances via a Diplomacy action.

Pair: Royal Pavilion, Forge
Complement: Senate Hall

The Forked Tongue

Two-Faced

Inspired by: Deceptive

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
HIGH

Masters of Duplicity: You may hold any number of treaties simultaneously with any number of players, regardless of contradiction. Your treaties are never automatically canceled or voided by game events. When a situation arises that would normally force a treaty to be canceled, you may choose which obligation to honor, keeping all other treaties intact. Other players may still end their treaties with you via the End Treaty action.

Pair: Thieves' Guild, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Hall of Masks

Shifting Identity

Inspired by: Doppelganger

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
HIGH

Mimic: At the beginning of every player's turn, pick another player's Faction. You gain that Faction for this turn. Next turn, you cannot select that Faction.

Pair: Studium Generale, Senate Hall
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Smoldering Crown

Aggressive, Destructive

Inspired by: Terrorists

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Reckless: Gain Influence +2 to all Cunning Envoys when targeting a Player with PO > 0. You begin the game with a Secret Cellar (no ward, no upkeep, always active Mastery). Cannot be in an alliance. Cannot perform Diplomacy actions. If you Send a Prowess envoy, it cannot fail — if condemned, it passes.

Pair: Thieves' Guild, Inquisitorial Palace
Complement: Royal Pavilion

The Squatters' Crown

Mobile Occupier

Inspired by: Insurgents

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Occupy: You start the game with an additional army. All must begin the game placed inside your settlements. You do not control your settlements when you leave them. To collect taxes or use Pursuits, end your turn inside that Settlement. To Occupy a Settlement, begin a Battle adjacent to the city like a Siege — instead, you Battle against the Garrison and Armies at war with you or owned by the same owner. If you win (or there is no force to fight), move inside. In the Upkeep Phase, only pay upkeep on equipment. You count as having all Infrastructure of Occupied Settlements and always count as 3 Trading Pursuits. When you leave a Settlement, you may not re-enter it until you Occupy another Settlement and a Trade Agreement is signed.

Pair: Royal Pavilion, Saddlery
Complement: Forge

The Wandering Crown

Nomads

Inspired by: Nomadic

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Wandering Nomads: Your armies function as settlements, classified as a Band, Tribe, or Horde and upgraded accordingly. You may have one additional army per Era, starting with two. Armies do not require troops to exist and cannot be besieged. Nomads cannot build infrastructure but may build pursuits. Raw Material pursuits within Reach are always considered active and do not take a settlement ward. Each army is considered to have a Muster Field. You may trade so long as your border touches another player's border. Armies count as settlements with a Reach of 3. When an army is destroyed, so is its settlement. You may begin a new army adjacent to any existing army by using either the Charter Settlement or Muster Army actions. Nomads do not pay any upkeep.

Pair: Saddlery, Royal Pavilion

Complement: Forge

The Dukedom

King of the Castle

Inspired by: The Game

DIFFICULTY
HIGH

STRENGTH
HIGH

The Great Arbiter: The Duke begins the game trading with all players under a Non-Aggression Pact. The Duke cannot join alliances, perform Cunning actions, or Declare War. If a player declares war on the Duke, that player's Trade Agreements, Non-Aggression Pacts, and Defensive Alliances are immediately and permanently voided. Their Military Alliance remains intact. All other players simultaneously declare war on that player and their Military Alliance. These cannot be reinstated while at war with the Duke. The Duke sees all private actions, resolves player actions, and manages Bandit Mechanics. If the Duke is eliminated, the game ends. The Duke may optionally choose a faction.

Pair: Senate Hall, Aristocratic Court

Complement: Royal Pavilion, Imperial Palace

The Elder Grove

Cautious Quickfighters

Inspired by: Elves

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Wise & Suspicious: Gain Doubt +1; If Public Order is 1+, armies gain +1l, Steady, and Speed +1. Cannot be a member of an alliance.

Pair: Forge

Complement: Inquisitorial Palace

The Yew Heart

Skilled Volleys

Inspired by: English Longbows

DIFFICULTY
LOW

STRENGTH
MEDIUM

Archery is a Way of Life: You begin the game with a Fletchery which does not occupy a Settlement ward, nor cost upkeep. You always gain its Mastery Effect, which cannot be deactivated. In addition, your armies must always be equipped with a ranged weapon. Ranged Weapons gain +1 to Strike. Cannot be equipped with full plate or articulated gothic plate. Cannot use shields. Cannot build a Preceptory of Knight's Templar.

Pair: Royal Pavilion

Complement: Senate Hall